Topic-Based Vocabulary, Phrases & Collocations

1. TRAVEL & VISITING PLACES

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Excursion

A short journey or trip, usually for pleasure.

Example:
We went on a short excursion to a nearby historical village, which gave us an opportunity to experience the local culture.

2.Expedition

A journey undertaken for a particular purpose, especially exploration or research.

Example:
The researchers embarked on an expedition to a remote part of the country to study its natural environment.

3.Sojourn

A short stay in a particular place.

Example:
During my sojourn in Singapore, I had the opportunity to explore its multicultural society.

4.Landmark

A famous or easily recognisable place or building.

Example:
The Burj Khalifa is an iconic landmark that attracts millions of tourists every year.

5.Attraction

A place or activity that attracts visitors.

Example:
The National Museum is one of the city's most popular tourist attractions.

6.Destination

A place to which people travel.

Example:
Cox's Bazar has become a popular tourist destination because of its breathtaking coastline.

7.Heritage site

A place that has historical, cultural or architectural importance.

Example:
The ancient mosque is an important heritage site that reflects the country's rich history.

8.Scenic spot

A place that is attractive because of its natural beauty.

Example:
The hilltop is a spectacular scenic spot where visitors can enjoy panoramic views of the surrounding area.

9.Point of interest

A place that is considered interesting or worth visiting.

Example:
The old railway station is an important point of interest for visitors exploring the city.

10.Cultural site

A location with cultural or historical significance.

Example:
The archaeological museum is an important cultural site that provides insight into the region's heritage.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.I had the opportunity to...

Example:
I had the opportunity to visit a number of historical sites during my trip to Istanbul.

2.A noteworthy experience was...

Example:
A noteworthy experience was attending a traditional cultural festival with local residents.

3.During my visit to...

Example:
During my visit to Cox's Bazar, I explored several less crowded areas away from the main tourist attractions.

4.I explored various aspects of...

Example:
I explored various aspects of the local culture, including traditional food, music and architecture.

5.I embarked on a journey to...

Example:
I embarked on a journey to the northern part of the country to experience its natural beauty.

6.The purpose of my visit was to...

Example:
The purpose of my visit was to learn more about the region's history and cultural heritage.

7.I had the privilege to explore...

Example:
I had the privilege to explore several historically significant places that are rarely visited by tourists.

8.My visit was particularly memorable because...

Example:
My visit was particularly memorable because I had the chance to interact with local people and learn about their traditions.

9.Renowned for its...

Example:
The city is renowned for its magnificent architecture and vibrant cultural scene.

10.A hotspot for tourism

Example:
The coastal area has become a hotspot for tourism because of its natural beauty and modern facilities.

11.A must-see destination

Example:
The old town is a must-see destination for anyone interested in history and architecture.

12.An iconic landmark

Example:
The Taj Mahal is an iconic landmark and one of the most recognisable buildings in the world.

13.The destination offers a unique blend of...

Example:
The destination offers a unique blend of natural beauty, cultural heritage and modern entertainment.

- **Band 9 Collocations**

1.Iconic landmark

Example:
The Eiffel Tower is an iconic landmark that symbolises Paris.

2.Historical significance

Example:
The building has considerable historical significance because several important events took place there.

3.Tourist destination

Example:
The area has developed into a major tourist destination over the past decade.

4.Cultural heritage

Example:
Travelling allows people to appreciate the cultural heritage of different societies.

5.Natural beauty

Example:
The region is particularly famous for its spectacular natural beauty.

6.Unique blend

Example:
The city offers a unique blend of traditional culture and modern lifestyles.

2. LEISURE & FREE TIME

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Downtime

Time when you are not working and can relax.

Example:
I usually spend my downtime reading books or listening to podcasts.

2.Pastime

An activity that someone regularly does for enjoyment.

Example:
Reading has been my favourite pastime since childhood.

3.Recreation

Activities that people do for enjoyment when they are not working.

Example:
Outdoor recreation is an excellent way to maintain both physical and mental well-being.

4.Respite

A short period of rest from something difficult or tiring.

Example:
After a demanding week at work, I need some respite from my usual routine.

5.Relaxation

The state of being free from stress or tension.

Example:
I consider reading an effective form of relaxation after a hectic day.

6.Leisure

Free time when one is not working.

Example:
People should make better use of their leisure time instead of spending hours on social media.

7.Idleness

A state of doing nothing.

Example:
Although occasional idleness can be relaxing, excessive idleness can reduce productivity.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.I allocate my leisure time to...

Example:
I allocate my leisure time to reading, exercising and spending quality time with my family.

2.During periods of respite, I prefer to...

Example:
During periods of respite, I prefer to disconnect from technology and spend time outdoors.

3.My ideal way to spend leisure time is...

Example:
My ideal way to spend leisure time is to visit a quiet place and read a thought-provoking book.

4.During my leisure time, I engage in...

Example:
During my leisure time, I engage in activities that allow me to develop new skills.

5.I often indulge in...

Example:
I often indulge in watching documentaries because they allow me to learn while relaxing.

6.To unwind, I prefer to...

Example:
To unwind, I prefer to take a long walk because it helps me clear my mind.

- **Band 9 Collocations**

1.Leisure activities

Example:
Engaging in leisure activities is essential for maintaining a healthy work-life balance.

2.Quality time

Example:
I try to spend quality time with my family whenever my schedule allows.

3.Leisure time

Example:
I usually use my leisure time to pursue activities that I genuinely enjoy.

4.Recreational activities

Example:
Schools should provide more opportunities for recreational activities.

5.Relaxing pastime

Example:
Reading is a relaxing pastime that helps me escape from the pressures of daily life.

3. BOOKS & READING

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Publication

A book, magazine or other written work that has been published.

Example:
The publication received considerable attention because it offered a fresh perspective on education.

2.Literary work

A piece of writing of artistic or intellectual value.

Example:
This literary work explores the complexities of human relationships.

3.Manuscript

An author's original written work before it is published.

Example:
The author spent several years revising the manuscript before submitting it to a publisher.

4.Narrative

The way in which a story or series of events is presented.

Example:
The narrative explores the challenges faced by young people in modern society.

5.Compelling storyline

A story that is extremely interesting and keeps the reader engaged.

Example:
The novel has a compelling storyline that kept me engaged from beginning to end.

6.Engrossing narrative

A story that attracts and holds one's attention.

Example:
It is an engrossing narrative that explores the consequences of difficult personal choices.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.An influential book that I read...

Example:
An influential book that I read was about personal development and the importance of lifelong learning.

2.This book offers profound insights into...

Example:
This book offers profound insights into human psychology and interpersonal relationships.

3.The narrative explores...

Example:
The narrative explores how social expectations can influence individual choices.

4.A compelling storyline that captivated me was...

Example:
A compelling storyline that captivated me was the relationship between two characters from completely different backgrounds.

5.This book provides a comprehensive overview of...

Example:
This book provides a comprehensive overview of the development of modern education.

6.The author's style is particularly captivating because...

Example:
The author's style is particularly captivating because the language is sophisticated without being difficult to understand.

7.This literary work has been lauded for...

Example:
This literary work has been lauded for its originality, emotional depth and powerful message.

4. MOVIES & FILMS

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Screenplay

The written script of a film.

Example:
The screenplay was particularly impressive because the dialogue felt realistic and natural.

2.Production

The process of making a film.

Example:
The production took several years because of the complexity of the scenes.

3.Cinematic work

A film considered as a work of art.

Example:
The director's latest cinematic work explores the impact of technology on modern relationships.

4.Feature

A full-length film.

Example:
The feature tells the story of a young man struggling to achieve his ambitions.

5.Documentary

A factual film about a particular subject.

Example:
I recently watched a thought-provoking documentary about climate change.

6.Cinematography

The art and technique of creating the visual appearance of a film.

Example:
The cinematography was exceptional, particularly in the scenes showing the natural landscape.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.The film's narrative structure is...

Example:
The film's narrative structure is particularly engaging because it gradually reveals the main character's past.

2.A poignant depiction of...

Example:
The film provides a poignant depiction of the difficulties faced by refugees.

3.The cinematography in this film is exceptional because...

Example:
The cinematography in this film is exceptional because the director uses natural light to create a realistic atmosphere.

4.This production was groundbreaking due to...

Example:
This production was groundbreaking due to its innovative approach to storytelling.

5.The film depicts...

Example:
The film depicts the struggles of ordinary people living through a period of social change.

6.A critically acclaimed movie...

Example:
A critically acclaimed movie I would highly recommend is one that explores the importance of family relationships.

7.The director masterfully portrays...

Example:
The director masterfully portrays the emotional struggles of the main character.

8.A thought-provoking film that addresses...

Example:
It is a thought-provoking film that addresses social inequality and the pressure faced by young people.

5. PROBLEMS & CHALLENGES

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Issue

A problem or matter that needs attention.

Example:
Traffic congestion is a serious issue in most major cities.

2.Challenge

A difficult situation that requires effort to overcome.

Example:
Finding a healthy balance between professional and personal life can be a major challenge.

3.Dilemma

A difficult situation in which you have to choose between two or more alternatives.

Example:
Many young professionals face the dilemma of choosing between career advancement and spending more time with their families.

4.Obstacle

Something that makes it difficult to achieve a goal.

Example:
A lack of financial resources can be a significant obstacle to higher education.

5.Predicament

A difficult or unpleasant situation.

Example:
The company found itself in a difficult predicament after losing one of its major clients.

6.Complication

Something that makes a situation more difficult.

Example:
Unexpected financial problems created an additional complication.

7.Conundrum

A difficult and confusing problem.

Example:
Finding affordable housing in major cities remains a serious conundrum.

8.Quandary

A difficult situation in which you do not know what decision to make.

Example:
I was in a quandary about whether to accept the job or continue my studies.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.A prevalent problem in today's society...

Example:
A prevalent problem in today's society is the increasing dependence on digital devices.

2.One of the major challenges we face is...

Example:
One of the major challenges we face is finding a balance between economic growth and environmental protection.

3.The issue has been exacerbated by...

Example:
The issue has been exacerbated by rapid urbanisation and inadequate public transport.

4.To address this dilemma...

Example:
To address this dilemma, governments need to introduce policies that support both employees and businesses.

5.A pressing problem in contemporary society is...

Example:
A pressing problem in contemporary society is the growing gap between the rich and the poor.

6.One of the persistent issues is...

Example:
One of the persistent issues is the lack of equal access to quality education.

7.The root cause of the problem lies in...

Example:
The root cause of the problem lies in poor planning and a lack of public awareness.

8.To mitigate this problem, it is necessary to...

Example:
To mitigate this problem, it is necessary to improve public transport and encourage people to use environmentally friendly alternatives.

6. PEOPLE & SOCIETY

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Citizens

People who legally belong to a particular country.

Example:
Responsible citizens should play an active role in improving their communities.

2.Individuals

Separate people considered independently.

Example:
Individuals have different perspectives depending on their personal experiences.

3.Populace

The people who live in a particular country or area.

Example:
The policy was widely welcomed by the local populace.

4.Society

A community of people living together within a particular system.

Example:
Modern society has become increasingly dependent on digital technology.

5.Demographic

A particular group of people within a population.

Example:
Young adults represent an important demographic for technology companies.

6.Constituents

People represented by an elected official.

Example:
Politicians should listen carefully to the concerns of their constituents.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.The collective mindset of the people...

Example:
The collective mindset of the people can have a significant influence on social change.

2.People exhibit a variety of perspectives on...

Example:
People exhibit a variety of perspectives on whether technology has improved the quality of life.

3.An essential aspect of human interaction is...

Example:
An essential aspect of human interaction is the ability to communicate effectively.

4.The social dynamics among people are shaped by...

Example:
The social dynamics among people are shaped by culture, education and economic circumstances.

5.The general consensus among people is...

Example:
The general consensus among people is that education should be accessible to everyone.

6.People from all walks of life...

Example:
People from all walks of life attended the cultural festival.

7. TECHNOLOGY

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Innovation

A new idea, method or technology.

Example:
Technological innovation has transformed the way people communicate.

2.Advancement

Progress or development in a particular area.

Example:
Recent advancements in medical technology have improved the diagnosis of many diseases.

3.Gadgetry

Technological devices considered collectively.

Example:
Modern gadgetry has made many everyday tasks considerably more convenient.

4.Digitalisation

The process of using digital technology.

Example:
The digitalisation of education has made learning resources more accessible.

5.Digital innovation

New ideas or developments involving digital technology.

Example:
Digital innovation has created new opportunities for businesses and consumers.

6.High-tech solutions

Advanced technological methods for solving problems.

Example:
Many industries are investing in high-tech solutions to improve efficiency.

7.Technological tools

Devices or systems that use technology to perform useful tasks.

Example:
Teachers increasingly rely on technological tools to make lessons more interactive.

8.Cutting-edge

Extremely modern and advanced.

Example:
The hospital has invested in cutting-edge medical equipment.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.The advent of technology has...

Example:
The advent of technology has transformed almost every aspect of modern life.

2.Technological advancements have revolutionised...

Example:
Technological advancements have revolutionised the way people access information.

3.A cutting-edge development in...

Example:
Artificial intelligence is a cutting-edge development in the field of technology.

4.The impact of technology on...

Example:
The impact of technology on education has been both significant and far-reaching.

5.The rapid pace of technological change has...

Example:
The rapid pace of technological change has made some traditional skills less relevant.

6.Emerging technologies have the potential to...

Example:
Emerging technologies have the potential to improve healthcare and make treatment more accessible.

7.The integration of technology in daily life...

Example:
The integration of technology in daily life has made communication faster and more convenient.

8.The role of technology in modern society is...

Example:
The role of technology in modern society is becoming increasingly significant.

8. APPS & DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Mobile application

A software application designed for a mobile device.

Example:
I use a mobile application to monitor my daily exercise and sleeping habits.

2.Software program

A set of instructions that enables a computer to perform specific tasks.

Example:
The company developed a software program to manage customer information.

3.Utility

Something useful or a program designed to perform a useful function.

Example:
This digital utility allows users to organise their files efficiently.

4.User interface

The way in which a user interacts with a digital system.

Example:
The app has a simple and user-friendly interface.

5.Functionality

The range of functions or activities that a system can perform.

Example:
The functionality of the application makes it particularly useful for students.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.The app's user-friendly interface allows for...

Example:
The app's user-friendly interface allows for quick and effortless navigation.

2.This software application is designed to...

Example:
This software application is designed to help users manage their personal finances.

3.The app has revolutionised the way we...

Example:
The app has revolutionised the way we communicate with friends and colleagues.

4.A feature-rich application that enhances...

Example:
It is a feature-rich application that enhances productivity and organisation.

5.This app facilitates...

Example:
This app facilitates communication between teachers, students and parents.

6.The functionality of the app includes...

Example:
The functionality of the app includes document sharing, video calls and instant messaging.

7.An innovative platform that offers...

Example:
It is an innovative platform that offers access to a wide range of educational resources.

9. GADGETS & DEVICES

- **Band 9 Vocabulary**

1.Instrument

A tool or device used for a particular purpose.

Example:
A smartphone has become an essential instrument for communication and information sharing.

2.Apparatus

A set of equipment designed for a particular purpose.

Example:
The laboratory is equipped with sophisticated scientific apparatus.

3.Tool

Something used to perform a particular task.

Example:
A laptop is an indispensable tool for students and professionals.

4.Multifunctional device

A device that performs several different functions.

Example:
A smartphone is a multifunctional device that combines communication, entertainment and productivity tools.

- **Band 9 Phrases**

1.A multifunctional device that is essential...

Example:
A smartphone is a multifunctional device that is essential for modern communication.

2.This device enables users to...

Example:
This device enables users to complete a wide range of tasks from virtually anywhere.

3.An advanced piece of technology...

Example:
A smartwatch is an advanced piece of technology that can monitor several aspects of physical activity.

4.The device is designed to...

Example:
The device is designed to make everyday tasks faster and more convenient.

5.A cutting-edge device that offers...

Example:
It is a cutting-edge device that offers several advanced security features.

6.This instrument is pivotal in...

Example:
This instrument is pivotal in helping doctors monitor patients' vital signs.

10. MONEY & FINANCIAL EXPRESSIONS

1.Short on cash

Having very little money available.

Example:
I'm a little short on cash this month because I have several unexpected expenses.

2.Pinching pennies

Being extremely careful about spending money.

Example:
I've been pinching pennies recently because I'm saving for a major purchase.

3.Well-off

Having enough money to live comfortably.

Example:
I would describe my family as reasonably well-off, although we try not to spend unnecessarily.

4.Loaded

Extremely wealthy.

Example:
Some successful entrepreneurs are incredibly loaded after selling their companies.

5.Filthy rich

Extremely wealthy.

Example:
A small number of business owners have become filthy rich through successful investments.

6.Rolling in dough

Having a great deal of money.

Example:
Some celebrities are practically rolling in dough because of their lucrative careers.

11. HAPPINESS & SUCCESS

1.Over the moon

Extremely happy.

Example:
I was absolutely over the moon when I found out that I had achieved my target IELTS score.

2.Flying high

Feeling extremely happy or successful.

Example:
After winning the national competition, the students were flying high with excitement.

3.Stroke of luck

An unexpected piece of good fortune.

Example:
Getting the last available ticket was a real stroke of luck.

4.Fingers crossed

Used to express hope that something will happen successfully.

Example:
I have an important interview tomorrow, so fingers crossed that everything goes well.

12. NEGATIVE FEELINGS & SITUATIONS

1.At the end of my rope

Feeling that you have no more patience or energy.

Example:
After dealing with the same problem for several weeks, I was completely at the end of my rope.

2.Bite my head off

Respond angrily to someone.

Example:
I only asked him a simple question, but he was so stressed that he bit my head off.

3.Black mood

A very unhappy or negative mood.

Example:
She was in a black mood after receiving the disappointing news.

4.Afraid of your own shadow

Extremely nervous or easily frightened.

Example:
When I was a child, I was afraid of my own shadow whenever I watched horror films.

5.Fed up

Extremely annoyed or tired of something.

Example:
I'm completely fed up with the constant traffic congestion in my city.

6.Bored to death

Extremely bored.

Example:
I was bored to death during the three-hour meeting because there was nothing relevant to me.

7.A bit down

Slightly unhappy or depressed.

Example:
I've been feeling a bit down recently because I haven't had enough time to see my friends.

8.Under the weather

Feeling slightly ill.

Example:
I'm feeling a little under the weather today, so I'd rather stay home and rest.

13. EVERYDAY IDIOMS

1.Once in a blue moon

Very rarely.

Example:
I only eat fast food once in a blue moon because I generally prefer healthy meals.

2.A hot potato

A controversial or difficult issue.

Example:
The issue of increasing university fees has become a political hot potato.

3.A piece of cake

Something very easy.

Example:
The first part of the test was a piece of cake because I had prepared thoroughly.

4.Hit the books

Study seriously.

Example:
I need to hit the books tonight because I have an important examination tomorrow.

5.Sit on the fence

Avoid making a decision or taking a position.

Example:
I tend to sit on the fence when I don't have enough information to make a sensible decision.

6.For ages

For a very long time.

Example:
I haven't visited my hometown for ages because I've been extremely busy with work.

7.Fishy

Suspicious or difficult to trust.

Example:
Something about his explanation seemed fishy, so I decided to investigate further.

8.Stretching the truth

Exaggerating or not telling the complete truth.

Example:
I think he was stretching the truth when he claimed that he had completed the entire project alone.

9.A drop in the ocean

A very small amount compared with what is needed.

Example:
The amount of funding provided was merely a drop in the ocean compared with the actual cost of the project.

10.Not up to the mark

Not meeting the expected standard.

Example:
The quality of customer service was simply not up to the mark.

14. THINKING TIME & NATURAL SPEAKING PHRASES

1.Let me think...

Example:
Let me think... I suppose the most useful invention would probably be the smartphone.

2.Hold a sec...

Example:
Hold a sec... I think I can remember a good example.

3.If I had to take a guess...

Example:
If I had to take a guess, I'd say that people will become increasingly dependent on artificial intelligence.

4.Off the top of my head...

Example:
Off the top of my head, I would say that travelling is one of the best ways to learn about different cultures.

5.I wouldn't be surprised if...

Example:
I wouldn't be surprised if online education became even more common in the next decade.

6.Funny you should ask that...

Example:
Funny you should ask that because I was actually discussing this topic with a colleague yesterday.